48/1). It stressed that since communism was global, rather than regional or local, the solution was not necessarily regional or local. Thus it would be "unwise" for the US to look toward India as a bulwark against communism in Asia.[76] At a meeting of US chiefs of mission in East Asia, officials also expressed doubts about the desirability and feasibility of building up Japan or India as dominant powers to counter China and the Soviet Union. India had not shown "constructive leadership," and it was preoccupied with internal matters. Moreover, any such assigned leadership would stir up countries like Pakistan or Sri Lanka.[77]

The evolving American strategic framework did, nonetheless, have a place for South Asia more broadly. This affected US policy in two ways that led to disagreements with Delhi. First, American policymakers put an even higher premium on stability in South Asia. While Indian policymakers would not have argued with this objective, the American assessment that the Kashmir dispute was one of the key threats to that stability—and required greater US involvement—came to be a major source of tension between the US and India.[78] Second, even though India was the bigger prize in most American policymakers' eyes, as NSC 48 outlined, it also became important to prevent Pakistan from falling to communism. And, in spring 1950, Pakistani prime minister Liaquat Ali Khan made clear that, while India might resist playing a role in the American script for Asia, his country was ready for a role.[79]

There was one area of US-India agreement on China, but it did not lead to convergence because of differences over means. The *New York Times* reported that one aspect of Nehru's prescription—pursuing a wedge strategy—had impressed the State Department.[80] Even before his visit, China watchers at State had argued against assuming Soviet control of the Chinese communists and stressed that Mao could act independently. Like Nehru, the American embassy in Moscow thought that US recognition of the communist Chinese government could help create a wedge between Beijing and Moscow. Acheson, in turn, believed that attempting to detach China from the Soviet Union would not constitute appeasement.

By the end of 1949, NSC 48/2 endorsed the idea of exploiting "rifts" between the communist giants.[81] But, while this US objective was defined, the means to achieve it were not as clear. Kennan recommended a hands-off American policy. Truman and Acheson, on the other hand, contemplated